

Make your computer boot from a USB Flash drive, such that it cannot boot into Windows XP otherwise!

Send in your solution with the subject "Take a Crack", and your postal address, to takeacrack@thinkdigit.com

Turn A USB drive Into A Key To Boot Into XP



LAST MONTH'S CHALLENGE

Win!



Take a Crack and win

Eclipse 2 for Java Developers

by Berthold Daum

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LAST MONTH'S WINNER

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Rules and Regulations

Readers are requested to send in their answers by the 15th of the month of publication.

Employees of Jasubhai Digital Media and their relatives are not permitted to participate in this contest.

Readers are encouraged to send their replies by e-mail. Jasubhai Digital Media will not entertain any unsolicited communication.

Jasubhai Digital Media is not responsible for any damage to your system that may be caused while you are trying to solve the problem.

Display the drive letter before the drive name in Explorer and change the colour of compressed files and folders

Task 1

Windows uses a special colour to identify compressed files in Explorer. By default, this is blue. You can set this to any colour of your choice:

Go to **My Computer > Tools > Folder Options > View**. Scroll down to "Show encrypted or compressed NTFS Files in Color"; check the box and click OK.

Then, open the Registry Editor. Navigate to **HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer**.

Create a new binary value, or modify the existing value, called **AltColor**, and set it to equal the hexadecimal RGB colour value for files and folders:

Value Name: **AltColor**
Data Type: **REG_BINARY** (Binary Value)
Value Data: **00 00 FF** (default)

Since we need to set the colour to red, we need to use a Value Data of **FF0000**. For other colours, the values are as follows.

Green: **00FF00**
Blue: **0000FF**
Yellow: **FFFF00**
White colour: **FFFFFF**
Black colour: **000000**
Brown colour: **A52A2A**

Task 2

By default, Windows Explorer will show drive labels in the form "<Volume Name> (DRIVE:)", for example, "Data (D:)". If you

are using shared drives from other computers, it will also append the server name—"my-shared-data on CORP-SERVER-1 (F:)"—so the drive letter is nearly invisible.

With the following setting, you can make the drive letter appear first, or make it behave differently for local drives and network drives. This change applies to all users on the computer.

Open the Registry Editor and navigate to **HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer**

Find the value called **ShowDriveLettersFirst**.

The possible values are:

0 = Default display; drive letters after description
1 = Network drive letters first, local drive letters after
2 = Descriptions only, no drive letters displayed
4 = Drive letters before description

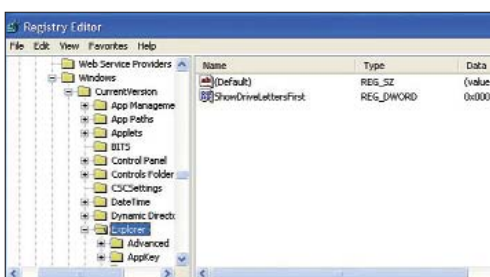
You could also use TweakUI if you don't want to use the Registry Editor. In TweakUI, the four options displayed are not associated with their correct values. The first option shows up correctly in TweakUI, but for "Show all drive letters before", TweakUI sets the value to 2 rather than 4; for

"Network before/Local after", the value is set to 2 rather than 1; and for "Never show", the value is set to 4 rather than 2.

To summarise (assuming the

options are numbered 1 through 4):

Option#	Select
1	1
2	4
3	2
4	3



Set the Registry value to display the drive letter before its label

